

Name: _____ Key _____

Cape Lookout Lighthouse: Interview with Heber Guthrie

As you listen to the interview with lighthouse ambassador Heber Guthrie, answer the following questions.

1. What was wrong with the original lighthouse built in the early 1800s?

It was too short (97 feet), used candles that weren't very bright, and ships continued to wreck in the area despite its presence.

2. Who was the first lighthouse keeper of the Cape Lookout Lighthouse?

James Fulford

3. How tall is the Cape Lookout Lighthouse?

163 feet to the top of the roof

4. Where do the diamonds on the lighthouse pattern face?

The black diamonds face north and south; the white diamonds face east and west

5. How often does the Cape Lookout Lighthouse flash?

Every 15 seconds (aerial beacon with two opposing lights that complete a rotation every 30 seconds).

6. How many steps does the Cape Lookout Lighthouse have?

About 207 steps to the balcony.

7. Why was the lighthouse turned off during World War II?

To prevent enemy submarines (U-boats) from using the light to navigate or target the coast.

8. What was the function of the Keeper's Quarters?

It housed the lighthouse keeper and assistants

9. What are the Keeper's Quarters used for today?

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The bottom floor is a museum, and the top floor is used as a living space for volunteers and park staff.

10. Who owns and maintains the lighthouse today?

The lighthouse is owned by the National Park Service, but the light itself is maintained by the U.S. Coast Guard.

Match each term with its correct meaning based on the interview.

Definition

- A. A method of building brick walls with headers and stretchers
- B. A powerful rotating beacon of light used in lighthouses
- C. Shallow areas in the ocean that can cause shipwrecks
- D. The glass enclosure at the top of the lighthouse where the light is housed
- E. A specialized lens made of many small prisms that magnifies light

Term

- E. Fresnel lens
- A. English bond
- C. Shoals
- D. Lantern room
- B. Beacon

Reflection Questions

Answer in 2–3 sentences each.

Why do you think it's important to preserve historical buildings like the Cape Lookout Lighthouse?

What part of Heber's story did you find most interesting or surprising? Why?